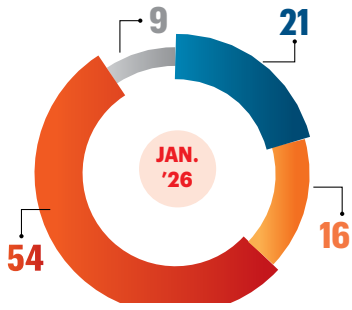
**Q. Under Donald Trump's second term, how have India–US relations changed?**



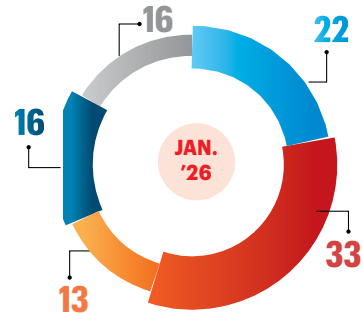

**Well over half think ties have suffered, but a significant minority feel otherwise**

**Q. How should India respond if Trump doesn't lower tariffs?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Retaliate with reciprocal tariff | 45 |
| Cut GST and take similar measures that can help offset the impact on Indian industry | 34 |
| Accept his demands | 6 |
| DK/ CS | 15 |

*All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say*

**Q. The US has captured Venezuelan president Nicolás Maduro and brought him to the US to face charges. Was this the right thing to do?**




**Nearly half of the respondents say Maduro's capture was illegal, or was done only to serve US interests**

from 27 per cent. Has India's global influence improved in recent years? Yes, say 57.7 per cent, down from 60 per cent in August.

New Delhi has taken a measured diplomatic response to atrocities against minorities in Bangladesh, voicing its concern, but avoiding a confrontationist approach. Most MOTN respondents are for more decisive action though, with only 25.1 per cent saying the government's actions are adequate, while 46.6 per cent advocate stronger measures.

## CAUTION WITH CHINA

Through measures like reopening direct flights and easing trade curbs, India and China are trying to bring bilateral relations back on track. Army chief Gen. Upendra Dwivedi has said that India's border with China is stable but needs constant vigil. MOTN respondents show similar caution when asked to rank India's priorities in managing ties with China. While 53.2 per cent favour bolstering border security compared to 56.5 per cent in August 2025, only 20.9 per cent believe it was desirable to enhance trade, compared to 22.3 per cent last time.

Trump's second term has been a rough time for India-US ties, with the 50 per cent tariffs he has imposed on Indian exports to the US. India has weathered some of the impact by expanding export destinations and concluding free trade agreements, including with the UK, Oman and most recently with the European Union on January 27. But the India-US trade deal has yet to see a breakthrough. With 53.6 per cent of the respondents recognising that Indo-US ties have worsened in Trump 2.0, over 45 per cent feel India should retaliate with reciprocal tariffs if the US does not withdraw the levies, while 33.6 per cent suggest other measures, such as cutting GST, to offset the impact.

Trump is also upset with India's refusal to validate his purported role in negotiating the ceasefire between India and Pakistan that ended the 87-hour conflict in May 2025 following Operation Sindoor. While Trump has made his claim over 60 times, India has been firm in its denial. Did the government effectively counter Trump's claims? MOTN respondents are divided. While 38.6 per cent believe India countered them very well, 37.6 per cent disagree.

Finally, on the US capturing Venezuelan president Nicolás Maduro and bringing him to the US to face alleged narco-terrorism charges, 33 per cent of the respondents see it as a violation of international law and national sovereignty, while 22.4 per cent favoured the US move. ■